Jonathan said unto him, [a] To-morrow is the new moon: and thou wilt be missed, because thy seat will be [1] empty. 19 And when thou hast stayed three days, thou shalt go down [2] quickly, and come to the place where thou didst hide thyself [3] when the business was in hand, and shalt remain by the stone Ezel. 20 And I will shoot three arrows on the side thereof, as though I shot at a mark. 21 And, behold, I will send the lad, *saying*, Go, find the arrows. If I say unto the lad, Behold, the arrows are on this side of thee; take [4] them, and come; for there is peace to thee and [5] no hurt, as Jehovah liveth. 22 But if I say thus unto the boy, [b] Behold, the arrows are beyond thee; go thy way, for Jehovah hath sent thee away. 23 And [c] as touching the matter which thou and I have spoken of, behold, [d] Jehovah is between thee and me for ever.

24 So David hid himself in the field: and when the new moon was come, the king sat him down to eat food. 25 And the king sat upon his seat, as at other times, even upon the seat by the wall; and Jonathan stood up, and Abner sat by Saul's side: but [e] David's place was empty. 26 Nevertheless Saul spake not anything that day: for he thought, Something hath befallen him, [f] he is not clean; surely he is not clean. 27 And it came to pass on the morrow after the new moon, *which was* the second *day*, that David's place was empty: and Saul said unto Jonathan his son, Wherefore cometh not the son of Jesse to meat, neither yesterday, nor to-day? 28 And Jonathan answered Saul, [g] David earnestly asked leave of me to go to Beth-lehem: 29 and he said, Let me go, I pray thee; for our family hath a sacrifice in the city; and my brother, he hath commanded me *to be there*: and now, if I have found favor in thine eyes, let me get away, I pray thee, and see my brethren. Therefore he is not come unto the king's table.

30 Then Saul's anger was kindled against Jonathan, and he said unto him, Thou son of a perverse rebellious woman, do not I know that thou hast chosen the son of Jesse to thine own shame, and unto the shame of thy mother's nakedness? 31 For as long as the son of Jesse liveth upon the ground, thou shalt not be established, nor thy kingdom. Wherefore now send and fetch him unto me, for [h] he [6] shall surely die. 32 And Jonathan answered Saul his father, and said unto him, [i] Wherefore should he be put to death? what hath he done? 33 And [k] Saul cast his spear at him to smite him; [l] whereby Jonathan knew that it was determined of his father to put David to death. 34 So Jonathan arose from the table in fierce anger, and did eat no food the second day of the month; for he was grieved for David, because his father had done him shame.

35 And it came to pass in the morning, that Jonathan went out into the field [7] at the time appointed with David, and a little lad with him. 36 And he said unto his lad, [m] Run, find now the arrows which I shoot. And as the lad ran, he shot an arrow [8] beyond him. 37 And when the lad was come to the place of the arrow which Jonathan had shot, Jonathan cried after the lad, and said, [n] Is not the arrow beyond thee? 38 And Jonathan cried after the lad, Make speed, haste, stay not. And Jonathan's lad gathered up the arrows, and came to his master. 39 But the lad knew not anything: only Jonathan and David knew the matter. 40 And Jonathan gave his weapons unto his lad, and said unto him, Go, carry them to the city. 41 And as soon as the lad was gone, David arose [9] out of *a place* toward the South, and fell on his face to the ground, and [o] bowed himself three times: and they kissed one another, and wept one with another, until [p] David exceeded. 42 And Jonathan said to David, [q] Go in peace, forasmuch as we have sworn both of us in the name of Jehovah, saying, [r] Jehovah shall be between me and thee, and between my seed and thy seed, for ever. *And he arose and departed: and Jonathan went into the city.

21 Then came David to [s] Nob to [t] Ahimelech the priest: and [u] Ahimelech came to meet David trembling, and said unto him, Why art thou alone, and no man

[a] ver. 5, 25
[b] ver. 37
[c] ver. 14, 15
[d] Gen. 31. 49, 53
[e] ver. 18
[f] ch. 16. 5; Lev. 7. 20, 21
[g] ver. 6

[h] 2 S. 12. 5
[i] ch. 19. 5
[k] ch. 18. 11; 19. 10
[l] ver. 7

[m] ver. 20, 21

[n] ver. 22

[o] Gen. 42. 6

[p] ch. 18. 3
[q] ver. 22

[r] ver. 15, 16, 23
*[Ch. 21. 1 in Heb.]

[s] ch. 22. 19
[t] ch. 14. 3; Mk. 2. 26
[u] ch. 16. 4

1 Heb. *missed.* 2 Heb. *greatly.*
3 Heb. *in the day of the business.* See ch. 19. 2.
4 Or, *him* 5 Heb. *not* any *thing.*

6 Or, *is worthy to die* Heb. *is a son of death.*
7 Or, *to the place*
8 Heb. *making it pass over him.*
9 Heb. *from beside the South.*

David goes to Nob, and is helped by Ahimelech. He flees to Gath, and feigns Madness. He hides at Adullam and Mizpeh

with thee? 2 And David said unto Ahimelech the priest, The king hath commanded me a business, and hath said unto me, Let no man know anything of the business whereabout I send thee, and what I have commanded thee: and I have appointed the young men to such and such a place. 3 Now therefore what is under thy hand? give me five loaves of bread in my hand, or whatsoever there is present. 4 And the priest answered David, and said, There is no common bread under my hand, but there is [a] holy bread; if only the young men have kept themselves from women. 5 And David answered the priest, and said unto him, [b] Of a truth women have been kept from us about these three days; when I came out, the vessels of the young men were holy, [1] though it was but a common journey; how much more then to-day shall their vessels be holy? 6 So [c] the priest gave him holy *bread*; for there was no bread there but the showbread, that was taken from before Jehovah, to put hot bread in the day when it was taken away.

7 Now a certain man of the servants of Saul was there that day, detained before Jehovah; and his name was [d] Doeg the Edomite, the [2 e] chiefest of the herdsmen that belonged to Saul. 8 And David said unto Ahimelech, And is there not here under thy hand spear or sword? for I have neither brought my sword nor my weapons with me, because the king's business required haste. 9 And the priest said, [f] The sword of Goliath the Philistine, whom thou slewest [g] in the vale of [3] Elah, behold, it is here wrapped in a cloth behind the ephod: if thou wilt take that, take it; for there is no other save that here. And David said, There is none like that; give it me.

10 And David arose, and fled that day for fear of Saul, and went to [h] Achish the king of Gath. 11 And the [i] servants of Achish said unto him, Is not this David the king of the land? [k] did they not sing one to another of him in dances, saying,

Saul hath slain his thousands,
And David his ten thousands?

12 And David [l] laid up these words in his heart, and was sore afraid of Achish the king of Gath. 13 And he [m] changed his behavior before them, and feigned himself mad in their hands, and [4] scrabbled on the doors of the gate, and let his spittle fall down upon his beard. 14 Then said Achish unto his servants, Lo, ye see the man is mad; wherefore then have ye brought him to me? 15 Do I lack madmen, that ye have brought this fellow to play the madman in my presence? shall this fellow come into my house?

22 David therefore departed thence, and [n] escaped to [o] the cave of Adullam: and when his brethren and all his father's house heard it, they went down thither to him. 2 And every one that was in distress, and every one that was in debt, and every one that was [5] discontented, gathered themselves unto him; and he became captain over them: and there were with him [p] about four hundred men.

3 And David went thence to Mizpeh of Moab: and he said unto the king of Moab, Let my father and my mother, I pray thee, come forth, *and be* with you, till I know what God will do for me. 4 And he brought them before the king of Moab: and they dwelt with him all the while that David was in the stronghold. 5 And [q] the prophet Gad said unto David, Abide not in the stronghold; depart, and get thee into the land of Judah. Then David departed, and came into the forest of Hereth.

6 And Saul heard that David was discovered, and the men that were with him: now [r] Saul was sitting in Gibeah, under the tamarisk-tree [6] in Ramah, with his spear in his hand, and all his servants were standing about him. 7 And Saul said unto his servants that stood about him, Hear now, ye Benjamites; will the son of Jesse give every one of you fields and vineyards, [s] will he make you all captains of thousands and captains of hundreds, 8 that all of you have conspired against me, and [7] there is none that discloseth to me [t] when my son maketh a

[a] Lev. 24. 5–9; Mt. 12. 4
[b] Ex. 19. 14, 15
[c] Mt. 12. 3, 4; Mk. 2. 25
[d] ch. 14. 47; 22. 9; Ps. 52. title
[e] 1 Chr. 27. 29, 31
[f] ch. 17. 54
[g] ch. 17. 2
[h] Ps. 34. title
[i] Ps. 56. title
[k] ch. 18. 7; 29. 5
[l] Lk. 2. 19
[m] Ps. 34. title
[n] Ps. 57. title; 142. title
[o] Josh. 12. 15; 15. 35; 2 S. 23. 13
[p] ch. 23. 13; 25. 13
[q] 2 S. 24. 11; 1 Chr. 29. 29; 2 Chr. 29. 25
[r] ch. 14. 2; Judg. 4. 5
[s] ch. 8. 14; 1 Chr. 12. 16–18
[t] ch. 18. 3; 20. 16

[1] Or, *and it may be used as common* bread; *and especially since to-day it will be holy in respect of their vessels*
[2] Or, *mightiest*
[3] Or, *the terebinth*
[4] Or, *made marks*
[5] Heb. *bitter of soul.*
[6] Or, *on the height*
[7] Or, *there was none that disclosed it to me when my son made &c.*

league with the son of Jesse, and there is none of you [a] that is sorry for me, or discloseth unto me that my son hath stirred up my servant against me, to lie in wait, as at this day? 9 Then answered [b] Doeg the Edomite, who [1] stood by the servants of Saul, and said, [c] I saw the son of Jesse coming to Nob, to [d] Ahimelech the son of Ahitub. 10 And [e] he inquired of Jehovah for him, and [f] gave him victuals, and [g] gave him the sword of Goliath the Philistine.

11 Then the king sent to call Ahimelech the priest, the son of Ahitub, and all his father's house, the priests that were in Nob: and they came all of them to the king. 12 And Saul said, Hear now, thou son of Ahitub. And he answered, Here I am, my lord. 13 And Saul said unto him, Why have ye conspired against me, thou and the son of Jesse, in that thou hast given him bread, and a sword, and hast inquired of God for him, that he should rise against me, [h] to lie in wait, as at this day? 14 [i] Then Ahimelech answered the king, and said, And who among all thy servants is so faithful as David, who is the king's son-in-law, and is taken into thy council, and is honorable in thy house? 15 Have I to-day begun [k] to inquire of God for him? be it far from me: let not the king impute anything unto his servant, nor to all the house of my father; for thy servant knoweth nothing of all this, less or more. 16 And the king said, Thou shalt surely die, Ahimelech, thou, and all thy father's house. 17 And [l] the king said unto the [2] guard that stood about him, Turn, and slay the priests of Jehovah; because their hand also is with David, and because they knew that he fled, and did not disclose it to me. But the servants of the king would not put forth their hand to fall upon the priests of Jehovah. 18 And the king said to Doeg, Turn thou, and fall upon the priests. And Doeg the Edomite turned, and he fell upon the priests, and [m] he slew on that day fourscore and five persons [n] that did wear a linen ephod. 19 And Nob, the city of the priests, [o] smote he with the edge of the sword, both men and women, children and sucklings, and oxen and asses and sheep, with the edge of the sword.

20 And [p] one of the sons of Ahimelech, the son of Ahitub, named Abiathar, [q] escaped, and fled after David. 21 And Abiathar told David that Saul had slain Jehovah's priests. 22 And David said unto Abiathar, I knew on that day, when [r] Doeg the Edomite was there, that he would surely tell Saul: I have occasioned *the death* of all the persons of thy father's house. 23 Abide thou with me, fear not; for [s] he that seeketh my life seeketh thy life: for with me thou shalt be in safeguard.

23 And they told David, saying, Behold, the Philistines are fighting against [t] Keilah, and are robbing the threshing-floors. 2 Therefore David [u] inquired of Jehovah, saying, Shall I go and smite these Philistines? And Jehovah said unto David, Go, and smite the Philistines, and save Keilah. 3 And David's men said unto him, Behold, we are afraid here in Judah: how much more then if we go to Keilah against the armies of the Philistines? 4 Then David inquired of Jehovah yet again. And Jehovah answered him, and said, Arise, go down to Keilah; for [v] I will deliver the Philistines into thy hand. 5 And David and his men went to Keilah, and fought with the Philistines, and brought away their cattle, and slew them with a great slaughter. So David saved the inhabitants of Keilah. 6 And it came to pass, when Abiathar the son of Ahimelech [x] fled to David to Keilah, that he came down with an ephod in his hand.

7 And it was told Saul that David was come to Keilah. And Saul said, God hath [3] delivered him into my hand; for he is shut in, by entering into a town that hath gates and bars. 8 And Saul summoned all the people to war, to go down to Keilah, to besiege David and his men. 9 And David knew that Saul was devising mischief against him; and he said to [y] Abiathar the priest, [z] Bring hither the ephod. 10 Then said David, O Jehovah, the God of Israel, thy servant hath surely heard that Saul seeketh to come to Keilah, to

[a] ch. 23. 21
[b] Ps. 52. title
[c] ch. 21. 1
[d] ch. 14. 3; 21. 1
[e] ch. 10. 22
[f] ch. 21. 6, 9
[g] ch. 21. 9
[h] ver. 8
[i] ch. 19. 4, 5; 20. 32
[k] 2 Sam. 5. 19, 23
[l] 2 K. 10. 25; 2 Chr. 12. 10
[m] ch. 2. 31
[n] ch. 2. 18
[o] ch. 15. 3

[p] ch. 23. 9; 30. 7; 2 S. 2. 1; 1 K. 2. 26, 27
[q] ch. 2. 33
[r] ch. 21. 7
[s] 1 K. 2. 26
[t] Josh. 15. 44; Neh. 3. 17, 18
[u] ver. 4, 6, 9–12; 2 S. 5. 19, 23

[v] Josh. 8. 7; Judg. 7. 7

[x] ch. 22. 20

[y] ch. 22. 20
[z] ver. 6; ch. 30. 7

[1] Or, *was set over* [2] Heb. *runners.* [3] The Sept. has, *sold.*


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36
TYRE
GESHUR
MEDITERRANEAN SEA
NAPHTALI
ASHTAROTH
SEA OF GALILEE
MT. CARMEL
Plain of Esdraelon
ENDOR
SHUNEM
JEZREEL
BETH-SHAN
GILEAD
JABESH GILEAD
APHEK
Mt. Gilboa
BEZEK
GEBA
GAD
RAMOTH GILEAD
SHAALIM
Jabbok
MANASSEH
EPHRAIM
SHILOH
River Jordan
GILGAL
OPHRAH
BETHEL
BETH-HORON
LOWER
UPPER
SECU
MICHMASH
BETH-AVEN
EKRON
GIBEAH
RAMAH (NAIOTH)
BENJAMIN
NOB
GILGAL
AMMON
AIJALON
JERUSALEM
AZEKAH
GALLIM
BETHLEHEM
GATH
VALE OF ELAH
SOCOH
ADULLAM
KEILAH
PHILISTINES
JUDAH
HEBRON
ZUPH
EN-GEDI
ARNON
AROER
JEZREEL
ESHTEMOA
MAON
JATTIR
DEAD SEA
MOAB
Brook Besor to Shur
BEER-SHEBA
MIZPAH?
Way
ARÖER
HAVILAH
ZIKLAG
AMALEKITES
CANAAN
EDOM
THE SOUTH
HORMAH
WILDERNESS OF PARAN
ILLUSTRATING STORIES OF
SAUL AND DAVID
I SAMUEL 8:1—31:13
SCALE OF MILES.
0 5 10 15 20 25
LAND SEA DESERT
FRANK LLOYD ROSE, CARTOGRAPH
WILBER W. WHITE, M.A., PH.D., D.D., EDI
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35
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36

destroy the city for my sake. 11 Will the men of Keilah deliver me up into his hand? will Saul come down, as thy servant hath heard? O Jehovah, the God of Israel, I beseech thee, tell thy servant. And Jehovah said, He will come down. 12 Then said David, Will the men of Keilah deliver up me and my men into the hand of Saul? And Jehovah said, [a] They will deliver thee up. 13 Then David and his men, who were [b] about six hundred, arose and departed out of Keilah, and went [c] whithersoever they could go. And it was told Saul that David was escaped from Keilah; and he forbare to go forth. 14 And David abode in the wilderness in the strongholds, and remained in the hill-country in the wilderness of [d] Ziph. And Saul sought him every day, but [e] God delivered him not into his hand.

15 And David saw that Saul was come out to seek his life: and David was in the wilderness of Ziph in [1] the wood. 16 And Jonathan, Saul's son, arose, and went to David into [1] the wood, and [f] strengthened his hand in God. 17 And he said unto him, Fear not; for the hand of Saul my father shall not find thee; and thou shalt be king over Israel, and I shall be next unto thee; and [g] that also Saul my father knoweth. 18 And [h] they two made a covenant before Jehovah: and David abode in [1] the wood, and Jonathan went to his house.

19 Then [i] came up the Ziphites to Saul to Gibeah, saying, Doth not David hide himself with us in the strongholds in [1] the wood, in [k] the hill of Hachilah, which is on the south of [2] the desert? 20 Now therefore, O king, come down, according to all the desire of thy soul to come down; and [l] our part shall be to deliver him up into the king's hand. 21 And Saul said, Blessed be ye of Jehovah; [m] for ye have had compassion on me. 22 Go, I pray you, make yet more sure, and know and see his place where his [3] haunt is, *and* who hath seen him there: for it is told me that he dealeth very subtly. 23 See therefore, and take knowledge of all the lurking-places where he hideth himself, and come ye again to me [4] of a certainty, and I will go with you: and it shall come to pass, if he be in the land, that I will search him out among all the [5] thousands of Judah.

24 And they arose, and went to Ziph before Saul: but David and his men were in the wilderness of [n] Maon, in the Arabah on the south of [2] the desert. 25 And Saul and his men went to seek him. And they told David: wherefore he came down to the rock, and abode in the wilderness of Maon. And when Saul heard *that*, he pursued after David in the wilderness of Maon. 26 And Saul went on this side of the mountain, and David and his men on that side of the mountain: and David made haste to get away for fear of Saul; for Saul and his men [o] compassed David and his men round about to take them. 27 But there came a messenger unto Saul, saying, Haste thee, and come; for the Philistines have made a raid upon the land. 28 So Saul returned from pursuing after David, and went against the Philistines: therefore they called that place [6] Sela-hammahlekoth. *29 And David went up from thence, and dwelt in the strongholds of [p] En-gedi.

24 And it came to pass, [q] when Saul was returned from following the Philistines, that [r] it was told him, saying, Behold, David is in the wilderness of En-gedi. 2 Then [s] Saul took three thousand chosen men out of all Israel, and went to seek David and his men upon the rocks of the wild goats. 3 And he came to the sheepcotes by the way, where was a cave; and Saul [t] went in to cover his feet. Now [u] David and his men were [7] abiding in the innermost parts of the cave. 4 And the men of David said unto him, Behold, [v] the day of which Jehovah said unto thee, Behold, I will deliver thine enemy into thy hand, and thou shalt do to him as it shall seem good unto thee. Then David arose, and cut off the skirt of Saul's robe privily. 5 And it came to pass afterward, that [x] David's heart smote him, because he had cut off Saul's skirt. 6 And he said unto his men, [y] Jehovah for-

[a] ver. 20; Judg. 15. 10–13
[b] ch. 22. 2; 25. 13
[c] 2 S. 15. 20
[d] Josh. 15. 55; 2 Chr. 11. 8
[e] Ps. 32. 7
[f] ch. 30. 6; Neh. 2. 18
[g] ch. 20. 31; 24. 20
[h] ch. 18. 3; 20. 12–17; 2 S. 9. 1
[i] ch. 26. 1; Ps. 54. title
[k] ch. 26. 3
[l] ver. 12
[m] ch. 22. 8

[n] ch. 25. 2; Josh. 15. 55
[o] Ps. 17. 9

*[Ch. 24. 1 in Heb.]

[p] Josh. 15. 62; 2 Chr. 20. 2
[q] ch. 23. 28, 29
[r] ch. 23. 19
[s] ch. 26. 2
[t] Judg. 3. 24
[u] Ps. 57. title; 142. title
[v] ch. 23. 17; 25. 28–30
[x] 2 S. 24. 10
[y] ch. 26. 11

[1] Or, *Horesh* [2] Or, *Jeshimon* [3] Heb. *foot.*
[4] Or, *with the certainty* Or, *to a set place*
[5] Or, *families*
[6] That is, *The rock of divisions* (or, *escape*).
[7] Or, *sitting*

bid that I should do this thing unto my lord, Jehovah's anointed, to put forth my hand against him, seeing he is Jehovah's anointed. 7 So David checked his men with these words, and suffered them not to rise against Saul. And Saul rose up out of the cave, and went on his way.

8 David also arose afterward, and went out of the cave, and cried after Saul, saying, My lord the king. And when Saul looked behind him, [a] David bowed with his face to the earth, and did obeisance. 9 And David said to Saul, Wherefore hearkenest thou to men's words, saying, Behold, David seeketh thy hurt? 10 [b] Behold, this day thine eyes have seen how that Jehovah had delivered thee to-day into my hand in the cave: and [c] some bade me kill thee; but *mine eye* spared thee; and I said, I will not put forth my hand against my lord; for he is Jehovah's anointed. 11 Moreover, [d] my father, see, yea, see the skirt of thy robe in my hand; for in that I cut off the skirt of thy robe, and killed thee not, know thou and see that there is neither evil nor transgression in my hand, and I have not sinned against thee, though thou [1] [e] huntest after my life to take it. 12 [f] Jehovah judge between me and thee, and Jehovah avenge me of thee; but my hand shall not be upon thee. 13 As saith the proverb of the ancients, [g] Out of the wicked cometh forth wickedness; but my hand shall not be upon thee. 14 After whom is the king of Israel come out? after whom dost thou pursue? after a dead dog, [h] after a flea. 15 [i] Jehovah therefore be judge, and give sentence between me and thee, and see, and [k] plead my cause, and [2] deliver me out of thy hand.

16 And it came to pass, when David had made an end of speaking these words unto Saul, that Saul said, [l] Is this thy voice, my son David? And Saul lifted up his voice, and wept. 17 [m] And he said to David, Thou art more righteous than I; for [n] thou hast rendered unto me good, whereas I have rendered unto thee evil. 18 And thou hast declared this day how that thou hast dealt well with me, forasmuch as when [o] Jehovah had delivered me up into thy hand, thou killedst me not. 19 For if a man [p] find his enemy, will he let him go well away? wherefore Jehovah reward thee good for that which thou hast done unto me this day. 20 And now, behold, [q] I know that thou shalt surely be king, and that [r] the kingdom of Israel shall be established in thy hand. 21 [s] Swear now therefore unto me by Jehovah, that thou wilt not cut off my seed after me, and that thou wilt not destroy my name out of my father's house. 22 And David sware unto Saul. And Saul went home; but David and his men gat them up unto [t] the stronghold.

25 [u] And Samuel died; and all Israel gathered themselves together, and [v] lamented him, and [x] buried him in his house at Ramah. And David arose, and went down to the [y] wilderness of Paran.

2 And there was a man in [z] Maon, whose [3] possessions were in [a] Carmel; and the man was [b] very great, and he had three thousand sheep, and a thousand goats: and [c] he was shearing his sheep in Carmel. 3 Now the name of the man was Nabal; and the name of his wife Abigail; and the woman was of good understanding, and of a beautiful countenance: but the man was churlish and evil in his doings; and he was of [d] the house of Caleb. 4 And David heard in the wilderness that Nabal was shearing his sheep. 5 And David sent ten young men, and David said unto the young men, Get you up to Carmel, and go to Nabal, and greet him in my name: 6 and [4] thus shall ye say to him that liveth *in prosperity*, [e] Peace be unto thee, and peace be to thy house, and peace be unto all that thou hast. 7 And now I have heard [f] that thou hast shearers: thy shepherds have now been with us, and we [5] did them no hurt, [g] neither was there aught missing unto them, all the while they were in Carmel. 8 Ask thy young men, and they will tell thee: wherefore let the young men find favor in thine eyes;

[a] ch. 25. 23, 24; 1 K. 1. 31
[b] Ps. 7. 3, 4
[c] ver. 4
[d] 2 K. 5. 13
[e] ch. 23. 14, 23; 26. 20
[f] ch. 26. 10, 23; Gen. 31. 53; Judg. 11. 27
[g] Mt. 7. 16–20
[h] ch. 26. 20
[i] ver. 12
[k] Ps. 35. 1
[l] ch. 26. 17
[m] ch. 26. 21
[n] Mt. 5. 44

[o] ch. 26. 23
[p] ch. 23. 17
[q] ch. 23. 17
[r] ch. 13. 14
[s] ch. 20. 14–17; Gen. 21. 23; 2 S. 21. 6–8
[t] ch. 23. 29
[u] ch. 28. 3

[v] Dt. 34. 8
[x] 2 K. 21. 18; 2 Chr. 33. 20
[y] Gen. 21. 21; Num. 10. 12; 13. 3
[z] ch. 23. 24
[a] Josh. 15. 55
[b] 2 S. 19. 32
[c] 2 S. 13. 23

[d] ch. 30. 14; Josh. 15. 13

[e] 1 Chr. 12. 18

[f] 2 S. 13. 23, 24
[g] ver. 15, 21

[1] Or, *layest wait for*
[2] Heb. *give sentence for me.*
[3] Or, *business was*
[4] Or, *thus shall ye say, All hail! and peace be unto thee &c.*
[5] Heb. *put them not to shame.*

for we come in [e]a good day: give, I pray thee, whatsoever cometh to thy hand, unto thy servants, and to thy son David.

9 And when David's young men came, they spake to Nabal according to all those words in the name of David, and [1]ceased. 10 And Nabal answered David's servants, and said, [b]Who is David? and who is the son of Jesse? there are many servants now-a-days that break away every man from his master. 11 Shall I then take my bread, and my water, and my [2]flesh that I have killed for my shearers, and give it unto men of whom I know not whence they are? 12 So David's young men turned on their way, and went back, and came and told him according to all these words. 13 And David said unto his men, Gird ye on every man his sword. And they girded on every man his sword; and David also girded on his sword: and there went up after David about [c]four hundred men; and two hundred [d]abode by the baggage.

14 But one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal's wife, saying, Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness to [3][e]salute our master; and he railed at them. 15 But the men were very good unto us, and we were not [4][f]hurt, neither missed we anything, as long as we went with them, when we were in the fields: 16 [g]they were a wall unto us both by night and by day, all the while we were with them keeping the sheep. 17 Now therefore know and consider what thou wilt do; for evil is determined against our master, and against all his house: for he is such a worthless fellow, that one cannot speak to him.

18 Then Abigail made haste, and [h]took two hundred loaves, and two [5]bottles of wine, and five sheep ready dressed, and five measures of parched grain, and a hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on asses. 19 And she said unto her young men, [i]Go on before me; behold, I come after you. But she told not her husband Nabal. 20 And it was so, as she rode on her ass, and came down by the covert of the mountain, that, behold, David and his men came down toward her; and she met them. 21 Now David had said, Surely in vain have I kept all that this fellow hath in the wilderness, so that nothing was missed of all that pertained unto him: and he hath returned me evil for good. 22 [k]God do so [6]unto the enemies of David, and more also, [l]if I leave of all that pertain to him by the morning light so much as one man-child.

23 And when Abigail saw David, she hasted, and alighted from her ass, and fell before David on her face, [m]and bowed herself to the ground. 24 And she fell at his feet, and said, Upon me, my lord, upon me be the iniquity; and let thy handmaid, I pray thee, speak in thine ears, and hear thou the words of thy handmaid. 25 Let not my lord, I pray thee, regard this worthless fellow, even Nabal; for as his name is, so is he; [7]Nabal is his name, and folly is with him: but I thy handmaid saw not the young men of my lord, whom thou didst send. 26 Now therefore, my lord, as Jehovah liveth, and as thy soul liveth, seeing Jehovah hath withholden thee [8]from bloodguiltiness, and [n]from [9]avenging thyself with thine own hand, now therefore [o]let thine enemies, and them that seek evil to my lord, be as Nabal. 27 And now [p]this [10]present which thy servant hath brought unto my lord, let it be given unto the young men that follow my lord. 28 Forgive, I pray thee, [q]the trespass of thy handmaid: for [r]Jehovah will certainly make my lord a sure house, because my lord [s]fighteth the battles of Jehovah; and [t]evil shall not be found in thee all thy days. 29 And though man be risen up to pursue thee, and to seek thy soul, yet the soul of my lord shall be bound in the bundle of [11]life with Jehovah thy God; and the souls of thine enemies, them [u]shall he sling out, as from the hollow of a sling. 30 And it shall come to pass, when Jehovah shall have done to my lord according to all the good that he hath spoken concerning thee, and [v]shall have appointed thee prince over Israel,

[a] Neh. 8. 10-12
[b] Judg. 9. 28
[c] ch. 23. 13
[d] ch. 30. 24
[e] ch. 13. 10; 15. 13
[f] ver. 7, 21
[g] Ex. 14. 22
[h] 2 S. 16. 1; 1 Chr. 12. 40
[i] Gen. 32. 16, 20
[k] ch. 3. 17; 20. 13
[l] 1 K. 14. 10
[m] ch. 20. 41
[n] Heb. 10. 30
[o] 2 S. 18. 32
[p] ch. 30. 26; Gen. 33. 11
[q] ver. 24
[r] ch. 22. 14; 2 S. 7. 16
[s] ch. 18. 17
[t] ch. 24. 11; Ps. 7. 3
[u] Jer. 10. 18
[v] ch. 13. 14

[1] Or, *remained quiet* [2] Heb. *slaughter.*
[3] Heb. *bless.* [4] Heb. *put to shame.* [5] Or, *skins*
[6] The Syr. and some editions of Sept. have, *unto David.* [7] That is, *Fool.*
[8] Heb. *from coming into blood.*
[9] Heb. *thine own hand saving thee.*
[10] Heb. *blessing.* [11] Or, *the living*

31 that this shall be no [1] grief unto thee, nor offence of heart unto my lord, [2] either that thou hast shed blood without cause, or that my lord hath avenged himself. And [a] when Jehovah shall have dealt well with my lord, then remember thy handmaid.

32 And David said to Abigail, [b] Blessed be Jehovah, the God of Israel, who sent thee this day to meet me: 33 and blessed be thy discretion, and blessed be thou, [c] that hast kept me this day from bloodguiltiness, and from avenging myself with mine own hand. 34 For in very deed, as Jehovah, the God of Israel, liveth, [d] who hath withholden me from hurting thee, except thou hadst hasted and come to meet me, surely there had not been left unto Nabal by the morning light so much as one man-child. 35 So David received of her hand that which she had brought him: and he said unto her, [e] Go up in peace to thy house; see, I have hearkened to thy voice, and [f] have accepted thy person.

36 And Abigail came to Nabal; and, behold, he held [g] a feast in his house, like the feast of a king; and Nabal's heart was merry within him, for he was very drunken: wherefore [h] she told him nothing, less or more, until the morning light. 37 And it came to pass in the morning, when the wine was gone out of Nabal, that his wife told him these things, and his heart died within him, and he became as a stone. 38 And it came to pass about ten days after, that [i] Jehovah smote Nabal, so that he died.

39 And when David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, Blessed be Jehovah, that hath [k] pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and [l] hath kept back his servant from evil: and the evil-doing of Nabal [m] hath Jehovah returned upon his own head. And David sent and [n] spake concerning Abigail, to take her to him to wife. 40 And when the servants of David were come to Abigail to Carmel, they spake unto her, saying, David hath sent us unto thee, to take thee to him to wife. 41 And she arose, [o] and bowed herself with her face to the earth, and said, Behold, thy handmaid is a servant [p] to wash the feet of the servants of my lord. 42 And [q] Abigail hasted, and arose, and rode upon an ass, with five damsels of hers that followed her; and she went after the messengers of David, and became his wife.

43 David also took Ahinoam of [r] Jezreel; and they became both of them his wives. 44 Now Saul had given [s] Michal his daughter, David's wife, to [3] Palti the son of Laish, who was of [t] Gallim.

26 And the Ziphites came unto Saul to Gibeah, saying, [u] Doth not David hide himself in the hill of Hachilah, which is before [4] the desert? 2 Then Saul arose, and went down to the wilderness of Ziph, having [v] three thousand chosen men of Israel with him, to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph. 3 And Saul encamped in the hill of Hachilah, which is before [4] the desert, [x] by the way. But David abode in the wilderness, and [y] he saw that Saul came after him into the wilderness. 4 David therefore sent out spies, and understood that Saul was come [5] of a certainty. 5 And David arose, and came to the place where Saul had encamped; and David beheld the place where Saul lay, and [z] Abner the son of Ner, the captain of his host: and Saul lay within the [6] place of the wagons, and the people were encamped round about him.

6 Then answered David and said to Ahimelech [a] the Hittite, and to [b] Abishai the son of Zeruiah, brother to Joab, saying, Who [c] will go down with me to Saul to the camp? And Abishai said, I will go down with thee. 7 So David and Abishai came to the people by night: and, behold, Saul lay sleeping within the [6] place of the wagons, with his spear stuck in the ground at his head; and Abner and the people lay round about him. 8 Then said Abishai to David, God hath delivered up thine enemy into thy hand this day: now therefore let me smite him, I pray thee, with the spear to the earth at one stroke, and I will not smite him the second time. 9 And David said to Abishai, Destroy him not; for [d] who can put forth his hand against Jehovah's anointed, and be guiltless? 10 And

[a] ver. 30; Gen. 40. 14
[b] Ex. 18. 10
[c] ver. 26
[d] ver. 26
[e] ch. 20. 42; 2 K. 5. 19
[f] Gen. 19. 21
[g] 2 S. 13. 23
[h] ver. 19
[i] ch. 26. 10
[k] ch. 24. 15
[l] ver. 26, 34
[m] 2 S. 3. 28, 29
[n] S. S. 8. 8
[o] ver. 23

[p] Mk. 1. 7
[q] Gen. 24. 61–67
[r] Josh. 15. 56
[s] ch. 18. 27; 2 S. 3. 14
[t] Is. 10. 30
[u] ch. 23. 19; Ps. 54. title
[v] ch. 13. 2; 24. 2
[x] ch. 24. 3
[y] ch. 23. 15

[z] ch. 14. 50, 51; 17. 55

[a] Gen. 23. 3; 26. 34; Josh. 3. 10; 1 K. 10. 29; 2 K. 7. 6
[b] 1 Chr. 2. 15, 16
[c] Judg. 7. 10, 11

[d] ch. 24. 6, 7; 2 S. 1. 14, 16

[1] Heb. cause of *staggering*.
[2] Or, *so that thou shouldest shed &c.*

[3] In 2 S. 3. 15, *Paltiel*.
[4] Or, *Jeshimon* See ch. 23. 19.
[5] Or, *to a set place* See ch. 23. 23.
[6] Or, *barricade*

David said, As Jehovah liveth, [a] Jehovah will smite him; [1] or [b] his day shall come to die; or [c] he shall go down into battle, and perish. 11 [d] Jehovah forbid that I should put forth my hand against Jehovah's anointed: but now take, I pray thee, the spear that is at his head, and the cruse of water, and let us go. 12 So David took the spear and the cruse of water from Saul's head; and they gat them away: and no man saw it, nor knew it, neither did any awake; for they were all asleep, because [e] a deep sleep from Jehovah was fallen upon them.

13 Then David went over to the other side, and stood on the top of the mountain afar off; a great space being between them; 14 and David cried to the people, and to Abner the son of Ner, saying, Answerest thou not, Abner? Then Abner answered and said, Who art thou that criest to the king? 15 And David said to Abner, Art not thou a *valiant* man? and who is like to thee in Israel? wherefore then hast thou not kept watch over thy lord the king? for there came one of the people in to destroy the king thy lord. 16 This thing is not good that thou hast done. As Jehovah liveth, ye are [2] [f] worthy to die, because ye have not kept watch over your lord, Jehovah's anointed. And now see where the king's spear is, and the cruse of water that was at his head.

17 And Saul knew David's voice, and said, [g] Is this thy voice, my son David? And David said, It is my voice, my lord, O king. 18 And he said, [h] Wherefore doth my lord pursue after his servant? for what have I done? or what evil is in my hand? 19 Now therefore, I pray thee, let my lord the king hear the words of his servant. If it be [i] Jehovah that hath stirred thee up against me, [k] let him [3] accept an offering: but [l] if it be the children of men, cursed be they before Jehovah; for [m] they have driven me out this day that I should [4] not cleave unto the inheritance of Jehovah, saying, Go, serve other gods. 20 Now therefore, let not my blood fall to the earth away from the presence of Jehovah: for the king of Israel is come out to seek [n] a flea, as when one doth hunt a partridge in the mountains.

21 Then said Saul, [o] I have sinned: return, my son David; for I will no more do thee harm, because my life was precious in thine eyes this day: behold, I have played the fool, and have erred exceedingly. 22 And David answered and said, Behold [5] the spear, O king! let then one of the young men come over and fetch it. 23 And [p] Jehovah will render to every man his righteousness and his faithfulness; forasmuch as Jehovah delivered thee into my hand to-day, and [q] I would not put forth my hand against Jehovah's anointed. 24 And, behold, as thy life was much set by this day in mine eyes, so let my life be much [r] set by in the eyes of Jehovah, and let him [s] deliver me out of all tribulation. 25 Then Saul said to David, [t] Blessed be thou, my son David: thou shalt both do mightily, and shalt surely prevail. So [u] David went his way, and Saul returned to his place.

27 And David said in his heart, I shall now perish one day by the hand of Saul: [v] there is nothing better for me than that I should escape into the land of the Philistines; and Saul will despair of me, to seek me any more in all the borders of Israel: so shall I escape out of his hand. 2 And David arose, and passed over, he and [x] the six hundred men that were with him, unto [y] Achish the son of Maoch, king of Gath. 3 And David dwelt with Achish at Gath, he and his men, [z] every man with his household, even David with [a] his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the Carmelitess, Nabal's wife. 4 And it was told Saul that David was fled to Gath: and he sought no more again for him.

5 And David said unto Achish, If now I have found favor in thine eyes, let them give me a place in one of the cities in the [6] country, that I may dwell there: for why should thy servant dwell in the royal city with thee? 6 Then Achish gave him Ziklag that day: wherefore [b] Ziklag pertaineth unto the kings of Judah unto this day. 7 And the number of the days that David dwelt in the [6] country of the

[a] ch. 25. 26, 38
[b] Dt. 31. 14
[c] ch. 31. 6
[d] ch. 24. 6, 12
[e] Gen. 2. 21; 15. 12
[f] ch. 20. 31
[g] ch. 24. 16
[h] ch. 24. 9, 11-14
[i] 2 S. 16. 11
[k] Gen. 8. 21
[l] ch. 24. 9
[m] Josh. 22. 25-27
[n] ch. 24. 14

[o] ch. 15. 24, 30; 24. 17
[p] ch. 24. 19
[q] ch. 24. 12

[r] ch. 18. 30
[s] Ps. 54. 7

[t] ch. 24. 19

[u] ch. 24. 22

[v] ch. 26. 19

[x] ch. 25. 13
[y] ch. 21. 10; 1 K. 2. 39

[z] ch. 30. 3; 2 S. 2. 3
[a] ch. 25. 42, 43

[b] Josh. 15. 31; 19. 5; Neh. 11. 28

[1] Or, *either*
[2] Heb. *sons of death.*
[3] Heb. *smell.*
[4] Or, *have no share in*
[5] Another reading is, *the king's spear.*
[6] Heb. *field.*

Philistines was [a]a full year and four months.

8 And David and his men went up, and made a raid upon [b]the Geshurites, and the [1]Girzites, and [c]the Amalekites; for those *nations* were the inhabitants of the land, who were of old, as thou goest to [d]Shur, even unto the land of Egypt. 9 And David smote the land, and saved neither man nor woman alive, and [e]took away the sheep, and the oxen, and the asses, and the camels, and the apparel; and he returned, and came to Achish. 10 And Achish said, [2]Against whom have ye [f]made a raid to-day? And David said, Against the South of Judah, and against the South of [g]the Jerahmeelites, and against the South of [h]the Kenites. 11 And David saved neither man nor woman alive, to bring them to Gath, saying, Lest they should tell of us, saying, So did David, and so hath been his manner all the while he hath dwelt in the [3]country of the Philistines. 12 And Achish believed David, saying, He hath made his people Israel utterly to abhor him; therefore he shall be my servant for ever.

28 And it came to pass in those days, that [i]the Philistines gathered their [4]hosts together for warfare, to fight with Israel. And Achish said unto David, Know thou assuredly, that thou shalt go out with me in the host, thou and thy men. 2 And David said to Achish, Therefore thou shalt know what thy servant will do. And Achish said to David, Therefore will I make thee keeper of my head [k]for ever.

3 Now [l]Samuel was dead, and all Israel had lamented him, and buried him [m]in Ramah, even in his own city. And Saul had put away those that [n]had familiar spirits, and the wizards, out of the land. 4 And the Philistines gathered themselves together, and came and encamped [o]in Shunem: and Saul gathered all Israel together, and they encamped in [p]Gilboa. 5 And when Saul saw the host of the Philistines, he was afraid, and his heart trembled greatly. 6 And [q]when Saul inquired of Jehovah, [r]Jehovah answered him not, neither by [s]dreams, nor by [t]Urim, nor by prophets. 7 Then said Saul unto his servants, Seek me a woman that hath a familiar spirit, that I may go to her, and inquire of her. And his servants said to him, Behold, [u]there is a woman that hath a familiar spirit at [v]En-dor.

8 And Saul [z]disguised himself, and put on other raiment, and went, he and two men with him, and they came to the woman by night: and he said, [y]Divine unto me, I pray thee, by the familiar spirit, and [z]bring me up whomsoever I shall name unto thee. 9 And the woman said unto him, Behold, thou knowest [a]what Saul hath done, how he hath cut off those that have familiar spirits, and the wizards, out of the land: wherefore then layest thou a snare for my life, to cause me to die? 10 And Saul sware to her by Jehovah, saying, As Jehovah liveth, there shall no [5]punishment happen to thee for this thing. 11 Then said the woman, Whom shall I bring up unto thee? And he said, Bring me up Samuel. 12 And when the woman saw Samuel, she cried with a loud voice; and the woman spake to Saul, saying, Why hast thou deceived me? for thou art Saul. 13 And the king said unto her, Be not afraid: for what seest thou? And the woman said unto Saul, I see [6]a god coming up out of the earth. 14 And he said unto her, What form is he of? And she said, An old man cometh up; and [b]he is covered with a robe. And Saul perceived that it was Samuel, and [c]he bowed with his face to the ground, and did obeisance.

15 And Samuel said to Saul, Why hast thou disquieted me, to bring me up? And Saul answered, I am sore distressed; for the Philistines make war against me, and [d]God is departed from me, and [e]answereth me no more, neither by prophets, nor by dreams: therefore I have called thee, that thou mayest make known unto me what I shall do. 16 And Samuel said, Wherefore then dost thou ask of me, seeing Jehovah is departed from thee, and is become thine adversary? 17 And Jehovah hath done unto [7]thee, [f]as he spake by me: and Jehovah hath rent the kingdom

[a] ch. 29. 3
[b] Josh. 13. 2, 13
[c] ch. 15. 7, 8; Ex. 17. 8
[d] Ex. 15. 22
[e] ch. 15. 3; Job 1. 3
[f] ch. 23. 27
[g] ch. 30. 29; 1 Chr. 2. 9, 25
[h] Judg. 1. 16; 4. 11
[i] ch. 29. 1
[k] ch. 1. 22, 28
[l] ch. 25. 1
[m] ch. 7. 17
[n] ch. 15. 23; Lev. 19. 31; Dt. 18. 10
[o] 1 K. 1. 3; 2 K. 4. 8
[p] ch. 31. 1
[q] 1 Chr. 10. 13, 14
[r] Prov. 1. 28–31
[s] Num. 12. 6; Joel 2. 28
[t] Ex. 28. 30; 2 S. 8. 17

[u] Acts 16. 16
[v] Josh. 17.11; Ps. 83. 10
[z] 2 Chr. 18. 29; 35. 22
[y] Is. 8. 19
[z] Dt. 18. 10, 11
[a] ver. 3

[b] ch. 15. 27

[c] ch. 24. 8

[d] ch. 16. 13, 14; 18. 12
[e] ver. 6

[f] ch. 15. 28

[1] Another reading is, *Gizrites.*
[2] So Sept. and Vulg.
[3] Heb. *field.*
[4] Heb. *camps.*
[5] Or, *guilt come upon thee*
[6] Or, *gods*
[7] So Vulg. and some editions of Sept. The Heb. has *him.*

out of thy hand, and given it to thy neighbor, even to David. 18 Because [a]thou obeyedst not the voice of Jehovah, and didst not execute his fierce wrath upon Amalek, therefore hath Jehovah done this thing unto thee this day. 19 Moreover Jehovah will deliver Israel also with thee into the hand of the Philistines; and to-morrow [b]shalt thou and thy sons be with me: Jehovah will deliver the host of Israel also into the hand of the Philistines.

20 Then Saul fell straightway his full length upon the earth, and was sore afraid, because of the words of Samuel: and there was no strength in him; for he had eaten no bread all the day, nor all the night. 21 And the woman came unto Saul, and saw that he was sore troubled, and said unto him, Behold, thy handmaid hath hearkened unto thy voice, and [c]I have put my life in my hand, and have hearkened unto thy words which thou spakest unto me. 22 Now therefore, I pray thee, hearken thou also unto the voice of thy handmaid, and let me set a morsel of bread before thee; and eat, that thou mayest have strength, when thou goest on thy way. 23 But he refused, and said, I will not eat. [d]But his servants, together with the woman, constrained him; and he hearkened unto their voice. So he arose from the earth, and sat upon [e]the bed. 24 And the woman had a fatted calf in the house; and [f]she hasted, and killed it; and she took flour, and kneaded it, and did bake unleavened bread thereof: 25 and she brought it before Saul, and before his servants; and they did eat. Then they rose up, and went away that night.

29 Now [g]the Philistines gathered together all their hosts to [h]Aphek: and the Israelites encamped by the fountain which is in [i]Jezreel. 2 And the lords of the Philistines passed on by hundreds, and by thousands; and [k]David and his men passed on in the rearward with Achish. 3 Then said the princes of the Philistines, What *do* these Hebrews *here*? And Achish said unto the princes of the Philistines, Is not this David, the servant of Saul the king of Israel, [l]who hath been with me these days, or *rather* these years, and [m]I have found no fault in him since he fell away *unto me* unto this day? 4 But the princes of the Philistines were wroth with him; and the princes of the Philistines said unto him, Make the man return, that he may go back [n]to his place where thou hast appointed him, and let him not go down with us to battle, [o]lest in the battle he become an adversary to us: for wherewith should this *fellow* reconcile himself unto his lord? should it not be with the heads of these men? 5 Is not this David, [p]of whom they sang one to another in dances, saying,

Saul hath slain his thousands,
And David his ten thousands?

6 Then Achish called David, and said unto him, As Jehovah liveth, thou hast been upright, and thy going out and thy coming in with me in the host is good in my sight; [q]for I have not found evil in thee since the day of thy coming unto me unto this day: nevertheless the lords favor thee not. 7 Wherefore now return, and go in peace, that thou displease not the lords of the Philistines. 8 And David said unto Achish, [r]But what have I done? and what hast thou found in thy servant so long as I have been before thee unto this day, that I may not go and fight against the enemies of my lord the king? 9 And Achish answered and said to David, I know that thou art good in my sight, [s]as an angel of God: notwithstanding [t]the princes of the Philistines have said, He shall not go up with us to the battle. 10 Wherefore now rise up early in the morning [u]with the servants of thy lord that are come with thee; and as soon as ye are up early in the morning, and have light, depart. 11 So David rose up early, he and his men, to depart in the morning, to return into the land of the Philistines. And the Philistines went up to Jezreel.

30 And it came to pass, when David and his men were come to [v]Ziklag on the third day, that [x]the Amalekites had made a raid upon the South, and upon [y]Ziklag, and had smitten Ziklag, and burned it with fire, 2 and had taken captive the women *and all* that were therein, both small and great: [z]they slew not any, but carried them off, and went their way. 3 And when David and his men

[a] ch. 15. 9, 20, 26
[b] ch. 31. 2; Job 3. 17–19
[c] ch. 19. 5
[d] 2 K. 5. 13
[e] Esth. 1. 6; Ezek. 23. 41
[f] Gen. 18. 6, 7
[g] ch. 28. 1, 2
[h] ch. 4. 1; Josh. 12. 18
[i] 1 K. 18. 45; 21. 1; 2 K. 9. 30
[k] ch. 28. 1, 2
[l] ch. 27. 7
[m] ch. 27. 1–6; 1 Chr. 12. 19, 20
[n] ch. 27. 6
[o] ch. 14. 21
[p] ch. 18. 7; 21. 11
[q] ver. 3; ch. 27. 8–12
[r] ch. 27. 10–12
[s] 2 S. 14. 17, 20; 19. 27
[t] ver. 4
[u] 1 Chr. 12. 19, 22
[v] ch. 29. 4, 11
[x] ch. 15. 7; 27. 8–10
[y] ch. 27. 6, 8
[z] ch. 27. 11

came to the city, behold, it was burned with fire; and their wives, and their sons, and their daughters, were taken captive. 4 Then David and the people that were with him lifted up their voice and wept, until they had no more power to weep. 5 And [a] David's two wives were taken captive, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite. 6 And David was greatly distressed; for [b] the people spake of stoning him, because the soul of all the people was grieved, every man for his sons and for his daughters: but [c] David strengthened himself in Jehovah his God.

7 And [d] David said to Abiathar the priest, the son of Ahimelech, I pray thee, bring me hither the ephod. And Abiathar brought thither the ephod to David. 8 And [e] David inquired of Jehovah, saying, [1] If I pursue after this troop, shall I overtake them? And he answered him, Pursue; for thou shalt surely overtake *them*, [g] and shalt without fail recover *all*. 9 So David went, [h] he and the six hundred men that were with him, and came to the brook Besor, where those that were left behind stayed. 10 But David pursued, he and four hundred men; for [i] two hundred stayed behind, who were so faint that they could not go over the brook Besor.

11 And they found an Egyptian in the field, and brought him to David, and gave him bread, and he did eat; and they gave him water to drink; 12 and they gave him a piece of a cake of figs, and two clusters of raisins: and when he had eaten, [k] his spirit came again to him; for he had eaten no bread, nor drunk any water, three days and three nights. 13 And David said unto him, To whom belongest thou? and whence art thou? And he said, I am a young man of Egypt, servant to an Amalekite; and my master left me, because three days ago I fell sick. 14 We made a raid upon [l] the South of the Cherethites, and upon that which belongeth to Judah, and upon [m] the South of Caleb; and [n] we burned Ziklag with fire. 15 And David said to him, Wilt thou bring me down to this troop? And he said, Swear unto me by God, that thou wilt neither kill me, nor deliver me up into the hands of my master, and I will bring thee down to this troop.

16 And when he had brought him down, behold, they were spread abroad over all the ground, eating and drinking, and dancing, [2] because of [o] all the great spoil that they had taken out of the land of the Philistines, and out of the land of Judah. 17 And David smote them [p] from the twilight even unto the evening of the next day: and there escaped not a man of them, save four hundred young men, who rode upon [q] camels and fled. 18 And David recovered all that the Amalekites had taken; and David rescued his two wives. 19 And there was nothing lacking to them, neither small nor great, neither sons nor daughters, neither spoil, nor anything that they had taken to them: [r] David brought back all. 20 And David took all the flocks and the herds, *which* they drove before those *other* cattle, and said, [s] This is David's spoil.

21 And [t] David came to the two hundred men, who were so faint that they could not follow David, whom also they had made to abide at the brook Besor; and they went forth to meet David, and to meet the people that were with him: and when David came near [3] to the people, he [4] saluted them. 22 Then answered all the wicked men and base fellows, of those that went with David, and said, Because they went not with us, we will not give them aught of the spoil that we have recovered, save to every man his wife and his children, that he may lead them away, and depart. 23 Then said David, Ye shall not do so, my brethren, with that which Jehovah hath given unto us, who hath preserved us, and delivered the troop that came against us into our hand. 24 And who will hearken unto you in this matter? for [u] as his share is that goeth down to the battle, so shall his share be that tarrieth by the baggage: they shall share alike. 25 And it was so from that day forward, that he made it a statute and an ordinance for Israel unto this day.

26 And when David came to Ziklag, he sent of the spoil unto the

[a] ch. 25. 42, 43
[b] Ex. 17. 4
[c] ch. 23. 16; Ps. 18. 2; 27. 14
[d] ch. 23. 9
[e] ch. 23. 2, 4
[f] Ex. 15. 9
[g] ver. 18
[h] ch. 27. 2
[i] ver. 9, 21
[k] Judg. 15. 19
[l] ver. 1, 16; 2 S. 8. 18; Ezek. 25. 16
[m] Josh. 14. 13; 21. 11, 12
[n] ver. 1

[o] ver. 14
[p] ch. 11. 11
[q] ch. 15. 3; Judg. 7. 12
[r] ver. 8
[s] ver. 26-31

[t] ver. 10

[u] Num. 31. 27; Josh. 22. 8

[1] Or, *Shall I pursue*

[2] Or, *amidst* [3] Or, *with*
[4] Or, *asked them of their welfare*

Saul and his Sons slain by the Philistines. They are buried at Jabesh-gilead

elders of Judah, even to his friends, saying, Behold, [a] a [1] present for you of the spoil of [b] the enemies of Jehovah: 27 to them that were in [c] Beth-el, and to them that were in [d] Ramoth of the South, and to them that were in [e] Jattir, 28 and to them that were in [f] Aroer, and to them that were in [g] Siphmoth, and to them that were in [h] Eshtemoa, 29 and to them that were in Racal, and to them that were in the cities of [i] the Jerahmeelites, and to them that were in the cities of [k] the Kenites, 30 and to them that were in [l] Hormah, and to them that were in [m] Bor-ashan, and to them that were in Athach, 31 and to them that were in [n] Hebron, and to all the places where David himself and his men were wont to [o] haunt.

31 [p] Now the Philistines fought against Israel: and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down [2] slain [q] in mount Gilboa. 2 And the Philistines followed hard upon Saul and upon his sons; and the Philistines slew Jonathan, and [3] Abinadab, and Malchi-shua, the sons of Saul. 3 And [r] the battle went sore against Saul, and the archers overtook him; and he was greatly distressed by reason of the archers. 4 [s] Then said Saul to his armorbearer, Draw thy sword, and thrust me through therewith, lest [t] these uncircumcised come and thrust me through, and [4] abuse me. But his armorbearer would not; for he was sore afraid. [u] Therefore Saul took his sword, and fell upon it. 5 And when his armorbearer saw that Saul was dead, he likewise fell upon his sword, and died with him. 6 So Saul died, and his three sons, and his armorbearer, and all his men, that same day together.

7 And when the men of Israel that were on the other side of the valley, and they that were beyond the Jordan, saw that the men of Israel fled, and that Saul and his sons were dead, they forsook the cities, and fled; and the Philistines came and dwelt in them. 8 And it came to pass on the morrow, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, that they found Saul and his three sons fallen in mount Gilboa. 9 And they cut off his head, and stripped off his armor, and sent into the land of the Philistines round about, [v] to carry the tidings [x] unto the house of their idols, and to the people. 10 And they put his armor in the house of [y] the Ashtaroth; and [z] they fastened his body to the wall of [a] Beth-shan. 11 And when [b] the inhabitants of Jabesh-gilead heard concerning him that which the Philistines had done to Saul, 12 [c] all the valiant men arose, and went all night, and took the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons from the wall of Beth-shan; and they came to Jabesh, and [d] burnt them there. 13 And they took their bones, and [e] buried them under [f] the tamarisk-tree in Jabesh, and [g] fasted seven days.

[a] ch. 25. 27
[b] ch. 18. 17; 25. 28
[c] Josh. 15. 30; 19. 4
[d] Josh. 19. 8
[e] Josh. 15. 48; 21. 14
[f] 1 Chr. 11. 44
[g] 1 Chr. 27. 27
[h] Josh. 15. 50
[i] ch. 27. 10
[k] ch. 15. 6
[l] Josh. 12. 14; 15. 30; 19. 4
[m] Josh. 15. 42; 19. 7
[n] Josh. 14. 13–15; 21. 11–13; Num. 13. 22
[o] ch. 23. 22
[p] 1 Chr. 10. 1–12
[q] ch. 28. 4
[r] 2 S. 1. 6
[s] Judg. 9. 54
[t] Judg. 14. 3

[u] 2 S. 1. 6, 10
[v] 2 S. 1. 20
[x] Judg. 16. 23, 24
[y] ch. 7. 3; Judg. 2. 13
[z] ver. 12; 2 S. 21. 14
[a] Josh. 17. 11
[b] ch. 11. 1–13

[c] 2 S. 2. 4–7

[d] 2 Chr. 16. 14
[e] 2 S. 21. 12–14
[f] ch. 22. 6
[g] 2 S. 1. 12

[1] Heb. *blessing.*
[2] Or, *wounded*
[3] In ch. 14. 49, *Ishvi.*
[4] Or, *make a mock of me*